

August 30, 2021

The Federal Maritime Commission

Subject: Docket No. 20-15, Comments on PVO Financial Responsibility Rulemaking

To whom it may concern:

I am writing to provide feedback on the anticipated rule changes on Passenger Vessel Financial Responsibility. I will state up front that I have only read an article published on August 25, 2021 by CruiseCritic titled "Federal Maritime Commission Proposes Cancellation Rule Changes to Protect U.S. Cruise Ship Passengers".

I support the proposed change which would require that cruise lines give consumers a full refund within 60 days if a sailing is cancelled or boarding is delayed by three days or more, for any reason other than by government order or declaration. Furthermore, I also support the proposed change that if a sailing is delayed by a government order, the deadline for cruise lines to provide refunds is to be 180 days. I offer as support for these requirements the fact that cruise lines require immediate payment of deposits at the time of making a reservation and additionally require full payment for the cruise well before the sail date. There is no reason they should not be required to issue refunds within a reasonable time period.

Additionally, I would ask that cruise lines be required to directly contact consumers when a cruise is cancelled in instances wherein the cruise lines have previously recorded the consumers' contact information. My wife and I had a circumstance during 2021 where a cruise was cancelled by Norwegian Cruise Lines and they never informed us of the cancellation. I learned about the cancellation when I went to check our reservation and learned that we no longer had a reservation.

Sincerely, John L. Libbey, 27 Temple Hill Rd., Hughesville, PA 17737